

THE SEASON, IN FIVE-DAY WEEKS

Shōsho — 小暑

Early July — "lesser heat," the gathering of summer before its peak. Its three *kō* are all motion and air.

First kō Warm winds blow. The first evening you leave the door open and the inside and the outside become, briefly, one room.

Second kō Lotus blossoms open. The flower the tradition prizes most — beautiful, and rooted in the mud it rises out of.

Third kō Hawks learn to fly. The young of the year test the air. Everything is practising the long light while it lasts.

"The first warm night you leave the door open, the house grows a room."

